

LIGHTHOUSE

Know how likely your date is before you promise it

Flow metrics and Monte Carlo forecasts for software delivery, running on your own systems

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Lighthouse replaces estimated dates with forecasts you can check, without moving your data

1. **Dates built on estimates miss.** Story points barely track how long work really takes, and a forecast from an average promises more than the team delivers.
2. **Lighthouse forecasts from what teams have already finished.** It turns their throughput into dates with odds, for one team or a whole portfolio, with no estimation meetings.
3. **The forecasts can be checked.** Forecast Reality Check forecasts weeks that already happened and compares the result with what the team really finished.
4. **It runs inside your network.** One installation connects Jira, Azure DevOps, Linear and ServiceNow, and the work items stay in its own database on your systems.
5. **It is free to start.** Community covers 3 teams. Self-Service is CHF 2,000 and Enterprise CHF 10,000 a year, flat, not per user.

THE PROBLEM

The same story-point estimate covers work that takes a few days and work that takes almost half a year

Exhibit 1 · How long items estimated at 2 story points really took



One estimate, one size on the board, and a spread that no plan built on it can absorb.

Why estimates make weak forecasts

- Points barely track time. Plotted against cycle time, they showed almost no relationship.
- Estimates are noisy. Teams estimating similar features land far apart.
- Velocity drifts toward the plan once teams are compared on it.

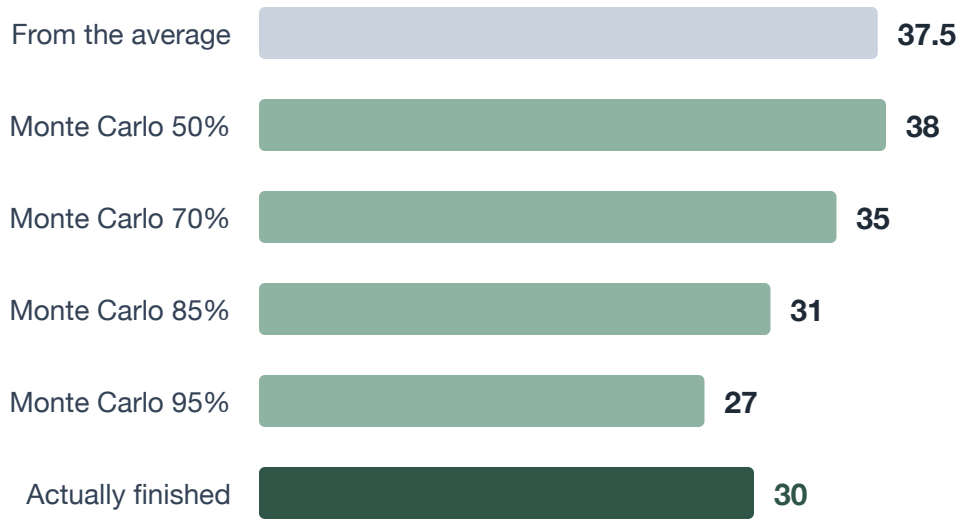
> If your teams find points useful for talking through work, keep them for that. A forecast doesn't need them.

Source: Peter Zylka-Greger, "Reality check through scatter plotting" (2024); "The hidden cost of noise in your delivery predictions" (2026), blog.letpeople.work

THE PROBLEM

An average promised 37.5 items in 30 days; the team finished 30, close to the 85% forecast of 31

Exhibit 2 · Items forecast for the next 30 days, one team of six developers



What the exhibit shows

- A forecast from the average is about as good as a coin flip: half the time the team does worse.
- A Monte Carlo forecast puts a probability on every number, so the risk is visible before anyone commits.
- For a promise outside the team, use the 85% line. For something that must make it, use 95%.

Source: Benjamin Huser-Berta, "The flaw of averages: comparing Monte Carlo simulations with estimates based on averages" (2023), blog.letpeople.work

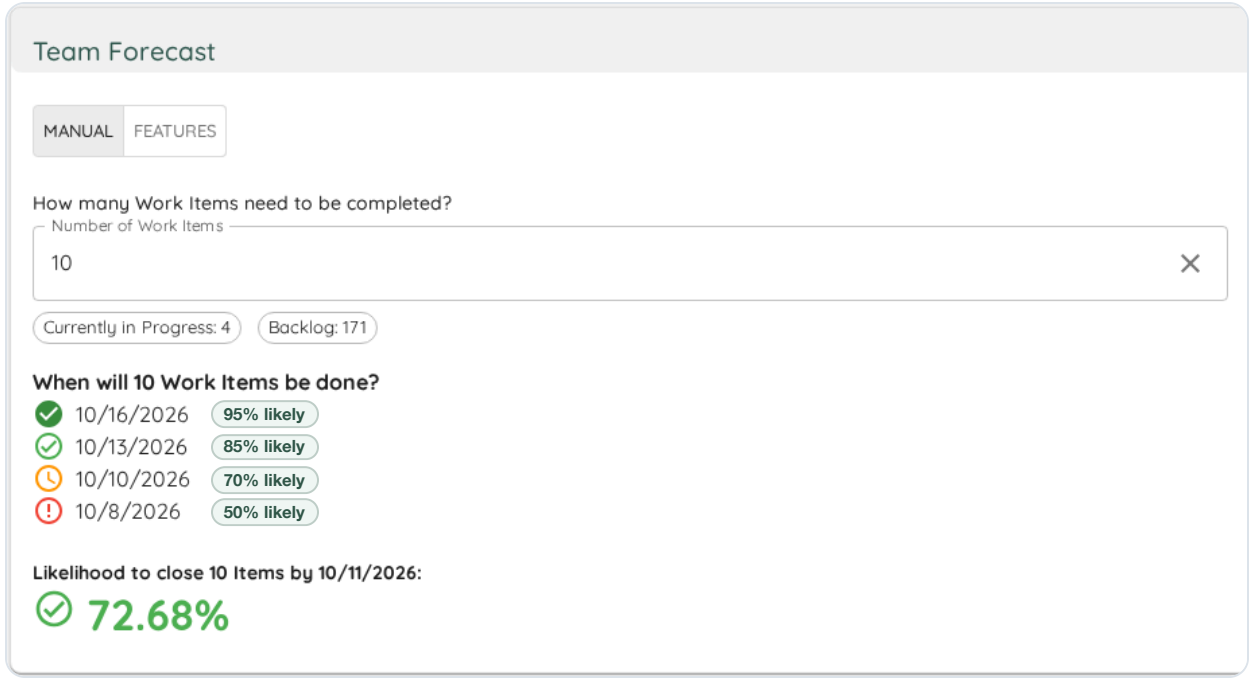
THE SOLUTION

Lighthouse turns the work a team has finished into dates with their odds

1. **Finished items per day**
   Read from the team's tracker. Every item that reached done has a date; no extra field and no estimate.

2. **10,000 simulated futures**
   Each future draws its days at random from the team's own history, holidays and sick days included.

3. **Dates with odds**
   When will these items be done, or how many by a date, at 50, 70, 85 and 95%. Forecasts refresh as work finishes.



A forecast in Lighthouse for a demo team: 10 items, 85% likely by 13 October.

Source: Lighthouse documentation, How Lighthouse forecasts (docs.lighthouse.letpeople.work)

THE SOLUTION

Lighthouse checks its own forecasts against weeks that already happened

12

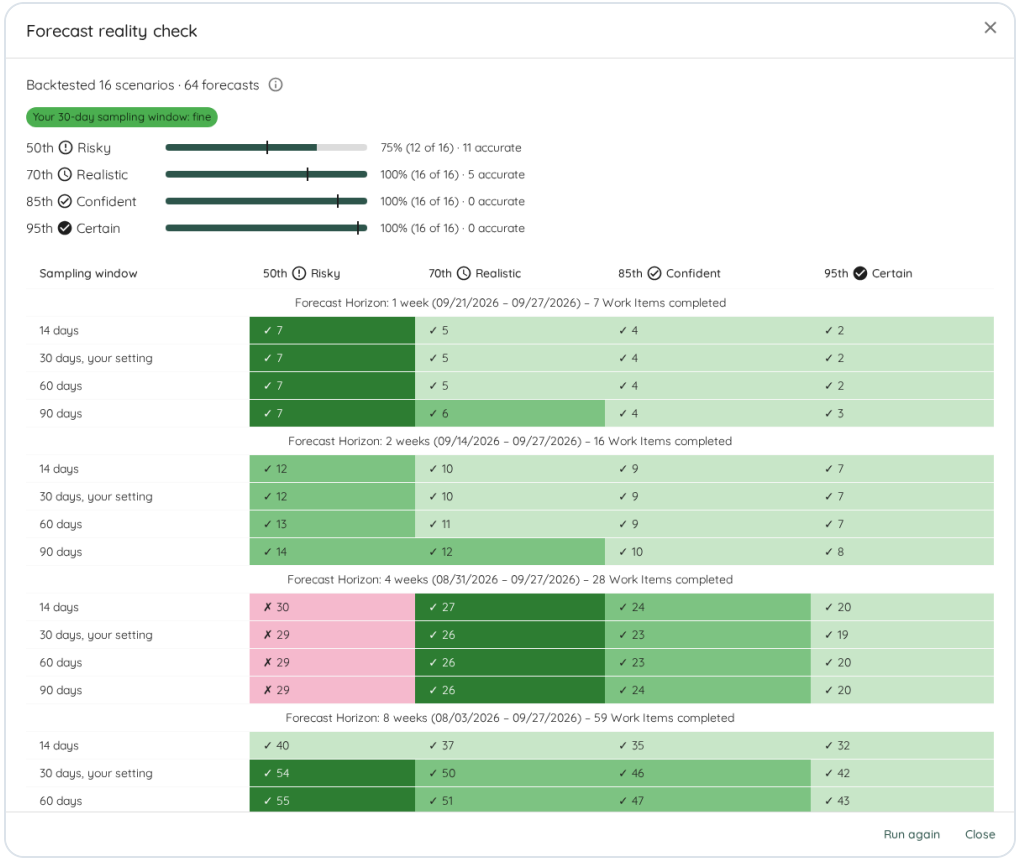
items: the 85% forecast for two weeks

16

items the team really finished

When Peter backtested his own team, the forecast he would have promised held, with room to spare.

- Forecast Reality Check forecasts past weeks as if they hadn't happened yet.
- It compares every percentile and history window with what the team then delivered.
- It tells you which percentile to trust for this team, before a steering committee asks.



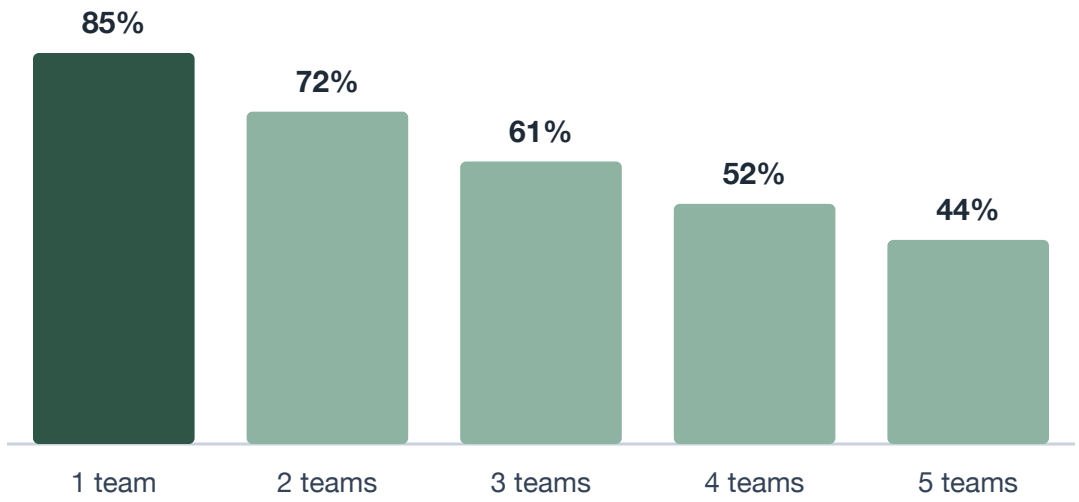
Forecast Reality Check in Lighthouse: backtests per percentile and history window.

Source: Peter Zylka-Greger, "How Lighthouse changed the way I work" (2026), blog.letpeople.work; Lighthouse documentation

PORTFOLIO

When several teams work on one feature, the odds of making a date drop fast; Lighthouse shows the joint probability

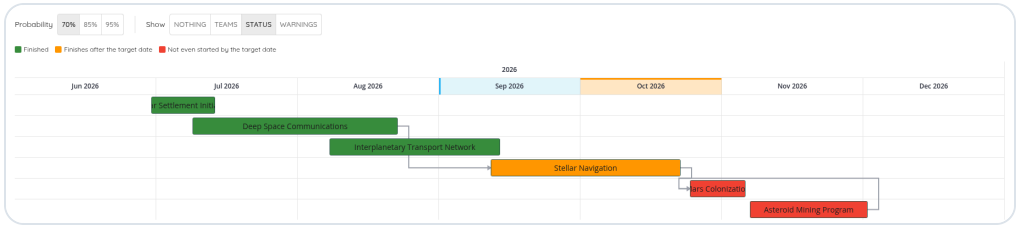
Exhibit 3 · Chance that every team makes a date each team is 85% sure of



0.85 multiplied by itself once per team, assuming the teams don't depend on each other.

What Lighthouse does with it

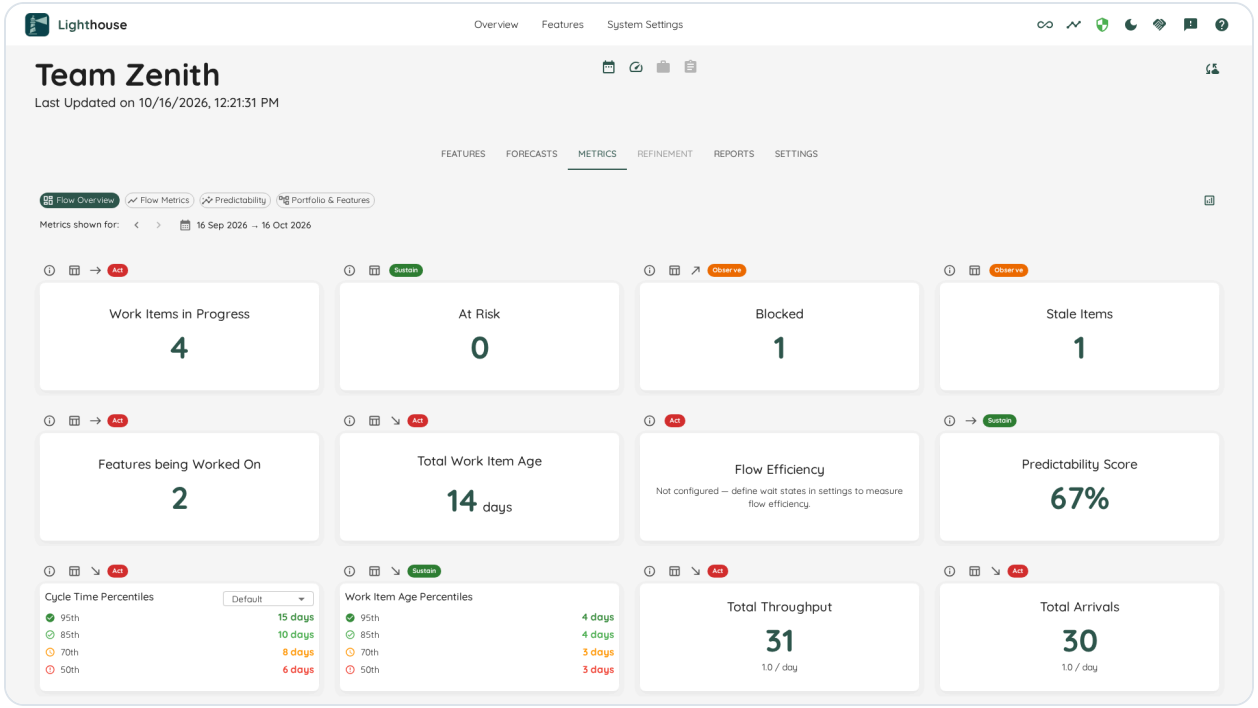
- Simulates every contributing team and combines them into one probability per feature and per delivery.
- Forecasts every feature in a portfolio continuously, in backlog order.
- Draws a delivery timeline per release, with dependencies from your tracker, so features that won't even start in time show up early.



Source: Benjamin Huser-Berta, "An introduction and step-by-step guide to multi-team Monte Carlo simulations" (2026), blog.letpeople.work; arithmetic as shown

FLOW METRICS

Flow metrics show where work gets stuck while there is still time to act



Team metrics in Lighthouse, each widget red, amber or green.

Work item age

Which items have been running for days, against the team's own cycle time

Risk of missing the SLE

Items about to take longer than the service level expectation

Blocked and stale items

What is waiting, and for how long

Cycle time and throughput

Percentiles, run charts and process behaviour charts

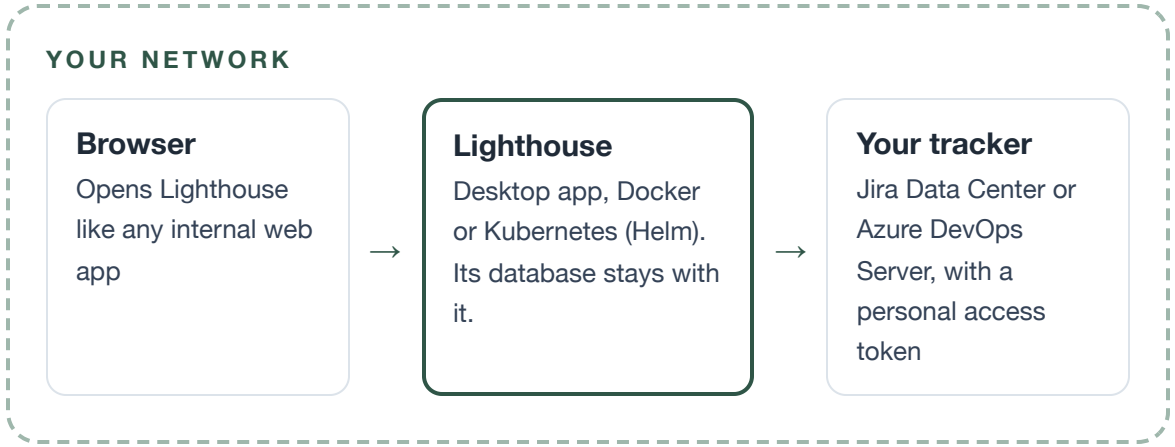
Reports

Then and Now compares the flow before a change with today

Source: Lighthouse documentation (docs.lighthouse.letpeople.work)

SECURITY AND HOSTING

Lighthouse runs where your data lives, so a tracker inside your network needs no way out



Hosted trackers
Jira Cloud, Azure DevOps Services, Linear and ServiceNow, through their API

LetPeopleWork
Receives nothing. Usage data is off unless someone turns it on, and never contains work items, names or queries.

- Source public on GitHub under the Lighthouse Source Available License, so security teams can read it
- SQLite by default, PostgreSQL supported
- Sign-in through your identity provider and role-based access on paid editions

Source: Lighthouse documentation; LetPeopleWork privacy policy

INTEGRATIONS

One installation connects the trackers your teams already use, and your AI assistant

Jira Cloud
API token, or OAuth on paid editions

Jira Data Center
Version 8 or later, personal access token

Azure DevOps Services
Personal access token, or OAuth through Entra ID on paid editions

Azure DevOps Server
Personal access token, inside your network

Linear
Connected through its API

ServiceNow
Connected through its API

CSV
For anything else

AI assistants
MCP server for Claude, Copilot and others, and the lh command line

> Teams on different trackers end up in one portfolio forecast. On paid editions, Lighthouse can write forecasts such as the 85% date back into a field in Jira or Azure DevOps.

Source: Lighthouse documentation, work tracking systems and AI integration

ALTERNATIVES

Compared with ActionableAgile and Nave, Lighthouse is the option that runs on your own systems at a flat price

	Lighthouse	ActionableAgile	Nave
Where it runs	On your systems: desktop app, Docker or Kubernetes	Web app, Jira Cloud and Data Center apps, Azure DevOps Services extension	Web app, Jira app
Where your data ends up	Lighthouse's own database on your systems	Data Center app inside your Jira; other editions in the vendor's or Atlassian's cloud	Nave's cloud, hosted in the EU
Trackers	Jira Cloud and Data Center, Azure DevOps Services and Server, Linear, ServiceNow, CSV	Jira Cloud and Data Center, Azure DevOps Services, Trello, files	Jira, Azure DevOps, Trello, Asana, CSV and JSON
Monte Carlo forecasts	Team, feature and portfolio, with backtests	Team; multi-team in a separate product for Jira Cloud	Completion dates and how many
Pricing model	Free for 3 teams; flat yearly licence	Per user	Per connected board
Source code	Public on GitHub	Not public	Not public

Source: Vendors' public pages and the Atlassian and Visual Studio marketplaces, checked October 2026; letpeople.work/compare

EDITIONS AND PRICING

Start free, then pay one flat yearly licence, whatever the number of users

COMMUNITY

Free

no time limit

- All flow metrics and Monte Carlo forecasts
- Up to 3 teams and 1 portfolio with 1 delivery
- Every tracker, AI integration

RECOMMENDED

SELF-SERVICE

CHF 2,000

per year

- Unlimited teams, portfolios and deliveries
- Sign-in through your identity provider, role-based access
- Rule-based deliveries, forecasts written back to your tracker

ENTERPRISE

CHF 10,000

per year

- Everything in Self-Service
- Prioritised support, 24h acknowledgement
- Two 60-minute onboarding calls, named contacts

The paid features are called Premium in the app; both paid editions include all of them. Setup help is free for every edition. Premium can be tried for 30 days without signing up.

Source: letpeople.work/lighthouse, pricing

WHAT TEAMS SAY

Teams use Lighthouse to plan across release trains, surface risk earlier and set clearer expectations

> Lighthouse transformed how our Agile Release Train operates: moving us **from guesstimations and overcommitment to data-driven PI Planning**. It streamlined progress tracking across teams, making delivery more transparent and predictable. With continuous forecasting, we're now better equipped to anticipate risks, align expectations, and deliver value with confidence.

Agnieszka Reginek
Professional Kanban Trainer, Scrum Master

> Lighthouse has transformed how we approach delivery. By prompting the right questions earlier and using the default feature size function to quickly forecast “how much?”, it provides **a lean, cost-effective way to surface risk and enable better decisions**.

Chris Graves
Agile Coach, Focusrite

> Lighthouse helped us be more on to it. **We’re now more predictable, efficient, and responsive** when it comes to delivering value and serving our customers. It’s made planning sessions run smoother and helped set clearer expectations with our stakeholders. The insights we get from the data really sharpen our conversations and keep us focused on what matters.

Gonzalo Mendez
Scrum Master, Mitre 10 (New Zealand)

Source: Quotes as given by the people named; letpeople.work/lighthouse

NEXT STEPS

A first forecast on your own data takes an afternoon, and the decision can wait until it has proven itself

1

DAY 1

Install and connect

On a laptop or a server, next to your tracker. Plan for about half an hour; in a recorded session, a Scrum Master did it in under ten minutes.

2

WEEK 1

First forecasts

Forecasts and flow metrics for up to 3 teams, free. We help with setup at no cost.

3

WEEKS 2 TO 4

Check the forecasts

Run Forecast Reality Check on your history. Try Premium for 30 days for the portfolio views.

4

THEN

Decide

Stay on Community, or choose Self-Service or Enterprise.

WHAT IT NEEDS FROM IT

A machine
A laptop, a VM, a Docker host or a Kubernetes cluster inside your network

Read access to the tracker
An API token or a personal access token for the projects in question

Nothing opened to the internet
Lighthouse calls your tracker; LetPeopleWork receives no work items

Source: Lighthouse documentation; Lighthouse Live session with Gábor Bittera (May 2026)

WHO WE ARE

Built by two practitioners who use it with their own teams



Benjamin Huser-Berta

Professional Kanban Trainer and software engineer. Builds Lighthouse and ships a new release about once a week. First ran Monte Carlo forecasts against Azure DevOps with a nightly script in 2023.



Peter Zylka-Greger

Delivery coach and speaker on flow and forecasting. Forecasts his own team's work with Lighthouse and backtested it: 12 items forecast at 85%, 16 finished.

Why we built it

The tools we found were fragmented, expensive and tied to the cloud, and their price grew with every user. So we built one that runs where the data lives, with the source public, and use it with our own teams first.

> LetPeopleWork GmbH, Zürich. We write about forecasting and flow, with step-by-step guides and real team data, at blog.letpeople.work.

See your own forecast before you decide anything

Download Lighthouse free at letpeople.work/lighthouse, or ask us for a 20-minute call.

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